

Under Hood Lighting

Monday, August 10, 2026 1:14 PM

I finally got to do a mod upgrade during day time so I could see what I'm doing! lol This past weekend I added my Matt Gecko under hood lighting kit to my rig. I also got pretty far on the bed lights (also part of that kit). Total cost for parts was ~ \$170 (part of this cost is for the bed lights too). Here are the parts/tools I used:

Matt Gecko Bed Light + Under Hood Light kit (<https://www.tundras.com/out/?url=https%3A%2F%2Fmattgeckoleds.com%2Fshop%2Fols%2Fproducts%2Fled-bed-light-kit-with-bed-mounted-switch-toyota-tacoma-2005-2021%2Fv%2FLED-BED-LGH-KIT-201-2029&inner=TWf0dCUyMEdly2tvJTIwQmVkJTIwTGlnaHQIMjAlMklIMjBVbmRlciUyMEhvb2QIMjBMaWdodCUyMGtpdA%3D%3D&post=3881662>) - \$151.50 total shipped I ordered this kit for my Tacoma and it was great quality and wanted to get it again.

As of this writing, they only have a kit for the 2nd gen Tundras. I emailed Matt and asked the question and it'll work just fine for our 3rd gens. I ordered the complete bed light and under hood light as one kit. You can order them separately if wanted one over the other.

\$10 RED WOLF Wire Harness Cloth Tape 1" x 50 FT Electric Wiring Loom Harness Flexibility High Abrasion Resistance Adhesive for Automobile Electrical Engine Noise Dampening Insulation 2 Rolls

Wire Harness Cloth Tape (<https://www.tundras.com/out/?url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.amazon.com%2Fdp%2FBOBW3SXFDR&inner=V2lyZSUyMEhhcm5lc3MIMjBDbG90aCUyMFRhcGU%3D&post=3881662&extra=relprodingp>) - \$9.99

I got this for this mod and future mods. I used to just trust wire with it's own insulation but was convinced to add this for extra protection where I run wires - just in case. Also with this being under the hood, there's extra head involved. Can honestly use any brand for this I'm sure - it's just the one I found on scAmazon. (optional)

\$7 DaierTek Door Pin Switch Car Hood Jamb Auto Alarm Security Adjustable Momentary ON Off 12VDC 20A for Automotive Trunk - 3Pcs
Momentary Door Pin Switches (<https://www.tundras.com/out/?url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.amazon.com%2Fdp%2FB081MT3YCF&inner=TW9tZW50YXJ5JTlwRG9vciUyMFBpbUyMFN3aXRjaGVz&post=3881662&extra=relproding>) - \$6.99

I got fancy with this one - decided to add these switches to activate the lights when the hood opened then they would turn off when closed. Matt provides an on/off switch that you can wire to, but I like the "automation" in my life. It's a pack of 3 on this link because I plan on adding something like this to our other vehicles. Also could get anything similar to this - it's just the one I found on scAmazon.

Add-a-circuit fuse tap - had an extra one around the shop from another project
Matt sends what you need to wire directly to the battery with inline 5A fuse but I decided to make this build a bit cleaner and add a fuse tap to one of my fuse boxes with a 5A fuse

Zip ties - had extra around the shop

A couple of flat washers - had some around the shop

Tools:

A couple beers

Wire strippers

Solder/butt connectors/some means of connecting wire to each other

Multimeter

About 1hr of time

I identified where I wanted the momentary hood switch. This spot on the right side between the washer fluid and headlight mount looked like the best.



Since the hole is bigger than I'd like for using just the stackup of nuts that came with the momentary switch, I added flat washers so it made a good connection.

I know... My hands need lotion...



Did a dry fit here and it looked great.



Just need to make sure you set the height correctly. You don't want the black spring plunger piece to bottom out when the hood is closed. I just went off a reference point for the nearby bump stop as a reference. Just want to make sure you still have some travel once it's roughly set to the top of the bump stop.



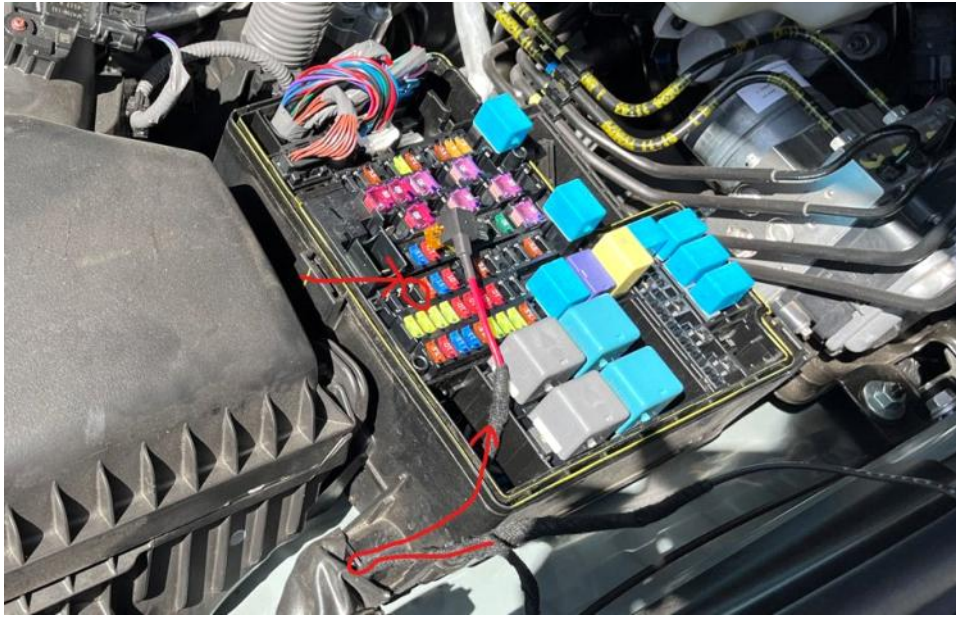
I didn't take any pictures of the wiring I did but it's pretty simple. The momentary switch I got came with about a 6" wire length that had a flat connector that would go over the flat end of the switch and just need to crimp that down, then the other end had a round terminal connector. I ended up cutting the round terminal connector off and just wiring that directly to the black lead from the under hood lights. I didn't need any additional wire for extra length. Between the length given from the momentary switch kit and what is on the lead from the lights, you should be good to go. I did have to strip back some of the protective wire cover to

give myself more positive and negative wire to work with.



Now, you can go ahead and get the positive end with an add-a-circuit fuse tap wired up. I decided to use an open fuse slot in the right side box, closest to my momentary switch location. I used my multimeter to check some open locations. I was interested in an always hot spot. There were many, but I went with the third one up from the bottom in the location I have circled below. That gave me enough room to physically install the add-a-circuit tap without it getting in the way of the fuse box when closed.

The best part about this fuse box is you can fish a wire up the bottom front facing end where a larger loom is. There's enough space, just have to be patient. I drew the path I fished the lead in the screenshot below. As you can see, I fished up the red lead from the lights first and had already wrapped in my harness cloth tape. Then when it got up a ways for me to work on it, I made the connection to my add-a-circuit lead. Then I cloth taped over that. Just make sure you find the proper direction to install the add-a-fuse. Should be able to see this with your multimeter.



Then I tucked up the black negative wire along the hood latch wire path and then behind the black covers there.



Finally, it was time to snake the lights around a path to get them up to the bottom end of the hood. I decided to follow the path of the wiper fluid line. I unwound the spool of lights and then started snaking it. Here is where I went behind the black cover then met up with the wiper fluid line.



Then I followed the fluid line very closely around the hood hinge point. This is where you want to be careful that you're out of the way from pinch points. Zip ties to the fluid line are your friend here. You also want to be careful with the wiper fluid line. I wrapped some of that cloth tape I had around the fluid line where I was planning to zip tie to it. Just for added protection to not wear that rubber line over time with vibration - also want you zip ties snug but not too tight for kinking the line. You can see the wiper fluid line tucks back in there pretty far then follows up the hinge - I tried to do the same thing with my wire for the lights.



I really wanted to drop a section of that black heat shield down but couldn't figure out how to pop out the black buttons that held it in place. I didn't want to break them. So, I just wrapped this section of the wire with more of the cloth tape and zip tied to one end of where the wiper fluid line went in and then tucked up the wire as best I could in the gap of the heat shield.



I took my time and placed the lights up around where I thought they would be to get the spacing correct. I may have been off a bit with more strand leading towards the left than the right but it's pretty centered up. I also wanted to make sure it was in a good spot so that when closed, it wasn't going to make contact with anything. Seemed like the curved portion just under the weather strip was best so I went with that. Here's the final placement:



You'll have extra line back in the engine bay, so I just zip tied it together and stuck it up under the black plastic covers here.



Then you're done!

I tested it a couple times and it works great. Here's the final product at dark, without headlights on to get the full effect:

